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ATTACHMENT 8

1987 Gallup Poll Concerning the UFO Phenomenon

This attachment includes the 1987 Gallup poll concerning the UFO phenomenon.

— The —
Gallup
— Poll —

Public Opinion 1987

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The following table compares the latest results with those from a 1981 survey, showing groups that were included in both surveys.

Selected National Trend		
	1987	1981*
Religious sects or cults	44%	30%
Religious fundamentalists	13	11
Unmarried couples	12	14
Hispanics	9	18
Jews	3	2
Protestants	2	1
Catholics	1	1

*In this survey, 25% and 17%, respectively, said they would not want Cuban or Vietnamese refugees as neighbors.

Note: Recent clashes between whites and blacks have underscored the extent of racial intolerance in the United States, but a new Gallup Poll also reveals a broad pattern of prejudice against diverse religious and ethnic minorities and persons with unconventional life-styles. Almost half the public, for example, would not like to have members of minority religious sects or cults as neighbors. Moreover, substantial proportions would be inhospitable to blacks and religious fundamentalists (13% each), unmarried couples (12%), and Hispanics (9%).

Comparatively few in the survey would object to living next door to Jews (3%), Protestants (2%), or Catholics (1%). One respondent in eight (12%) would have no objection to any of these groups as neighbors, while three in ten (29%) do not express opinions.

Hostility toward religious cults has grown significantly in recent years. In a 1981 survey, 30% said they would not welcome cult members as neighbors; currently, 44% would not. Black and Hispanic respondents are less likely than whites to object to cults, but their views about the other minority groups are similar to whites.

Southern whites tend to be less tolerant than whites living in other parts of the country in their acceptance of blacks, singles, and Hispanics.

Almost one-fourth of southern whites (23%) compared to 10% of whites outside the South, for example, would object to having black neighbors. In the case of unmarried couples, the figure for southern whites is 19%, while for non-South whites it is 10%. And 13% of southern whites, but only 8% of non-South whites, would not like to have Hispanics as neighbors. Religious cults and fundamentalists, however, would get about the same reception from whites in every region.

In general, college graduates exhibit somewhat greater tolerance toward the minority groups included in the survey than do the less well educated. People age 50 and over would be less hospitable to unmarried couples than those under 30.

MARCH 12

UNIDENTIFIED FLYING OBJECTS (UFOs)

Interviewing Date: 2/2-18/87
Special Telephone Survey

Have you heard or read about UFOs (unidentified flying objects)?

Yes
National 88%

Asked of those who replied in the affirmative:
Have you, yourself, ever seen anything you thought was a UFO?

Yes
National 9%

Selected National Trend

Yes
1978 9%
1973 11
1966 5

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Real
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Real
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Also asked of the aware group (88% of the sample): In your opinion, are UFOs something real, or just people's imagination?

Real49%
Imagination30
Not sure21

By Sex

Male

Real50%
Imagination31
Not sure19

Female

Real49%
Imagination28
Not sure23

By Education

Attended College

Real56%
Imagination26
Not sure18

No College

Real44%
Imagination33
Not sure23

By Region

East

Real52%
Imagination30
Not sure18

Midwest

Real48%
Imagination27
Not sure25

South

Real39%
Imagination39
Not sure22

West

Real62%
Imagination19
Not sure19

By Age

18-29 Years

Real53%
Imagination32
Not sure15

30-49 Years

Real57%
Imagination21
Not sure22

50 Years and Over

Real36%
Imagination39
Not sure25

Selected National Trend

	Real	Imagination	Not sure
1978	57%	27%	16%
1973	54	30	16
1966	46	29	25

Asked of the entire sample: Do you think there are people somewhat like ourselves living on other planets in the universe, or not?

Yes50%
No34
Not sure16

By Sex

Male

Yes62%
No30
Not sure8

Female

Yes40%
No28
Not sure32

By Education Attended College

Yes57%
No33
Not sure10

No College

Yes46%
No35
Not sure19

By Region East

Yes55%
No29
Not sure16

Midwest

Yes49%
No34
Not sure17

South

Yes38%
No48
Not sure14

West

Yes63%
No21
Not sure16

Selected National Trend

	Yes	No	Not sure
1978	51%	33%	16%
1973	46	38	16
1966	34	46	20

Note: For millions of American adults, a "close encounter of the third kind" is a distinct possibility, with only about one in three flatly denying

the existence of other unidentified flying objects (UFOs) or extraterrestrial life. In a new Gallup survey, 50% express the belief that "there are people somewhat like ourselves living on other planets in the universe," while 34% are skeptical and 16% unsure. The current figures are virtually unchanged from those recorded in a 1978 survey, but considerably more respondents now than in either 1973 or 1966 believe in extraterrestrial life.

Similarly, 49% of those who have heard or read about UFOs think they are real, while 30% say they are imaginary and 21% are uncertain. Belief in UFOs is down slightly from its peak in 1978, when 57% thought they were real. In the new survey, one person in eleven (9%) reports actually having seen something he or she thought was a UFO, a statistic similar to the findings of earlier polls.

Belief in the existence of life on other planets and in UFOs is substantially higher among persons who attended college than among those whose formal education ended at or before graduation from high school. Men are more likely than women to believe in extraterrestrial life, at 62% and 40%, respectively, but men and women share the same opinions about UFOs. As a rule, people age 50 and over are less convinced than their juniors that either phenomenon has a basis in fact, but more older than younger adults are undecided. Westerners are most apt to be believers, while southerners are least likely.

MARCH 15 JOB BIAS

Interviewing Date: 1/26-2/5/87
Special Telephone Survey

Do you feel that women in this country have equal job opportunities with men, or not?

Views of Women

Yes35%
No56
No opinion9

Yes
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No opin

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